

Reading

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A Walk Through the Old Town

Before you read

- Look at the title. What kind of places do you think 'the old town' has?
- Guess: what two historical things might you see on a walk through an old town?

Last weekend, my cousin Deren visited our city for the first time, so I took her on a walking tour of the old town. We started at the main square, where a tall stone monument stands. It was built over a hundred years ago, and it must be protected carefully because it is part of our cultural heritage.

From there, we walked to the old bazaar, a busy street full of small shops and cafés. Deren loved the atmosphere. 'Shall we buy something here?' she asked, and we bought some handmade souvenirs from a local craftsman.

Next, we visited the history museum, which has a new exhibition about the city's past. Photos can be taken in most rooms, but Deren asked, 'Can I take a photo of this old map, please?' The guide said yes, but explained that flash photography mustn't be used near the oldest documents.

After the museum, we climbed up to the old castle. The view from the top was amazing, and we could see the whole neighbourhood below. Some parts of the castle are closed because they should be restored before visitors can walk there safely.

By the end of the day, Deren said the old town was definitely worth visiting. 'This landmark might become my favourite place in the city,' she laughed. I was happy she loved a place I see every day.

1. What is the text mainly about?
 - a. A shopping trip in a new city
 - b. A walking tour of the old town
 - c. A history lesson at school
2. Why must the monument in the square be protected carefully?
 - a. Because it is very tall
 - b. Because it is part of the cultural heritage
 - c. Because it is in the bazaar
3. What does Deren ask permission for in the museum?
 - a. To touch the old map
 - b. To take a photo of the old map
 - c. To buy the old map

4. Why are some parts of the castle closed?

- a. They are too small
- b. They should be restored before visitors can go there safely
- c. They are used as an office

5. Flash photography can be used everywhere in the museum. — *True / False*

6. How does Deren feel about the old town at the end of the day?

- a. Bored
- b. Impressed — she thinks it's worth visiting
- c. Confused

After you read

- What is one cultural or historical place in your own neighbourhood or city? Write two sentences about it.
- Would you like to visit the old town in the text? Why or why not?

The Spring Street Festival

Before you read

- What festivals or events happen in your neighbourhood every year?
- Guess: what two things usually happen at a street festival?

Every spring, our neighbourhood holds a street festival to celebrate the end of winter. It's an old tradition that takes place on the first Saturday of April, and almost every family gets involved.

In the morning, a colourful procession moves down the main street. Local schools and dance groups perform traditional dances, and children carry flags and flowers. 'Shall we join the procession this year?' my neighbour asked me, and I said yes.

By midday, the street is full of small stalls selling food, crafts and music. The council always asks residents to help keep the street clean, because litter mustn't be dropped during the festival — there are extra bins everywhere.

In the evening, there is live music in the square, and the festival usually ends with fireworks over the river. The weather forecast said it might rain last year, so many people brought umbrellas just in case, but the sky stayed clear.

For me, the Spring Street Festival is the best event of the year. It brings the whole community together and shows how our traditions can be enjoyed by everyone, old and young.

1. What is the Spring Street Festival?

- a. A sports competition
- b. An old neighbourhood tradition celebrating the end of winter
- c. A monthly market

2. When does the festival take place?

- a. The first Saturday of April
- b. The last Sunday of March
- c. Every weekend in spring

3. Who performs in the procession?

- a. Only the council
- b. Local schools and dance groups
- c. Only local shop owners

4. Why does the council ask residents to help keep the street clean?

- a. Because litter mustn't be dropped during the festival
- b. Because the shops complain
- c. Because it rains a lot

5. It rained heavily during the festival last year. — *True / False*

6. How does the writer feel about the festival?

- a. Negative — too crowded
- b. Positive — it brings the community together
- c. Neutral — doesn't care

After you read

- Describe one tradition or festival in your neighbourhood. What happens there?
- Design one new activity that could be added to a neighbourhood festival.